

Θεόφιλος ὁ κωμικός

Theophilus the Comic Poet on Dining and Excess

eul_aid: ggs

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Κωμωδία Ἀττική* [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: *Κωμωδία* [Comedy](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Theophilus was an Athenian comic poet active in the 4th century BCE during the period of Middle Comedy. The Suda, a 10th-century Byzantine encyclopedia, records that he was the son of Theognetus. No further biographical details are known.

According to the Suda, Theophilus wrote 24 dramas, but only two titles survive: The Pancratiast and Philonides. His works are lost except for fragments, and he is recorded as having won first prize at the City Dionysia at least once.

Theophilus is a representative figure of Middle Comedy, the transitional phase between the political satire of Old Comedy and the social themes of New Comedy. His extant fragments contribute to the understanding of 4th-century Athenian theatrical conventions and language.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δείπνων καὶ Ἀκολασίας · [Comic Fragments on Dining and Excess](#) · 43 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δείπνων καὶ Ἀκολασίας · [Comic Fragments on Dining and Excess](#) · 42 passages